

Medford School Committee Meeting

March 8, 2021

Remote Meeting by ZOOM

Executive Session 5:00 PM

Regular Meeting 6:00 PM

Pursuant to Governor Baker's March 12, 2020 Order Suspending Certain Provisions of the Open Meeting Law, G.L. c. 30A, §18, and the Governor's March 15, 2020 Order imposing strict limitations on the number of people that may gather in one place, this meeting of the Medford School Committee will be conducted via remote participation to the greatest extent possible. Specific information and the general guidelines for remote participation by members of the public and/or parties with a right and/or requirement to attend this meeting can be found on the City of Medford website, at www.medfordma.org. For this meeting, members of the public who wish to listen or watch the meeting may do so by accessing the meeting link contained herein. No in-person attendance of members of the public will be permitted, but every effort will be made to ensure that the public can adequately access the proceedings in real time, via technological means. In the event that we are unable to do so, despite best efforts, we will post on the City of Medford or Medford Community Media websites an audio or video recording, transcript, or other comprehensive record of proceedings as soon as possible after the meeting.

The meeting can be viewed through Medford Community Media on Comcast Channel 22 and Verizon Channel 43 at 6:00 pm.

Meeting of the Medford School Committee Virtual Information - 5:00 PM Since the meeting will be held remotely, participants can log or call in by using the following link or call-in number:

Join Zoom Meeting

<https://mps02155-org.zoom.us/j/99479394090>

Meeting ID: 994 7939 4090

One tap mobile

+13017158592,,99479394090# US (Washington DC)

+13126266799,,99479394090# US (Chicago)

Dial by your location

+1 929 205 6099 US (New York)

Meeting ID: 994 7939 4090

Find your local number: <https://mps02155-org.zoom.us/j/aeqjCImNEa>

Additionally, questions or comments can be submitted during the meeting by emailing medfordsc@medford.k12.ma.us. Those submitting must include the following information:

1. Your first and last name
2. Your Medford street address
3. Your question or comment

I. Roll Call and Salute the Flag

II. Negotiations and Legal Matters - Executive Session

Executive session of the Medford School Committee pursuant to G.L.c. 30A §21(a) in preparation for negotiations with nonunion personnel, specifically the negotiation process involving the Superintendent's individual employment agreement. The Medford School Committee will reconvene in public session following the executive session.

II. Approval of Minutes:

1. February 22, 2021 School Committee Meeting

III. Approval of Bills/Transfer of Funds and Approval of Payrolls

IV. Report of Secretary

V. Report of Committees

1. Curriculum Subcommittee, Feb. 24, 2021 - Paulette Van der Kloot, Chair
2. Committee of the Whole Meeting, March 1, 2021 - Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn, Recommendation to approve Evaluation of Superintendent Marice Edouard-Vincent, SY 2019-2020
3. Communication, Stakeholder Engagement and Strategic Planning Subcommittee Meeting, March 2, 2021 - Jenny Graham, Chair

4. Buildings & Grounds Subcommittee Meeting, March 3, 2021 - Kathy Kreatz, Chair

VI. Community Participation

Public Participation Emails: Questions or comments can be submitted during the meeting by emailing medfordsc@medford.k12.ma.us. Those submitting must include the following information:

1. Your first and last name
2. Your Medford street address
3. Your question or comment

VII. Report of Superintendent

1. Superintendent's Updates and Comments
2. COVID-19 Public Health Update & MPS COVID-19 Testing Summary and Update & Vaccine Update- Nurse Supervisor Toni Wray, Ms. MaryAnn O'Connor - Board of Health & Mr. David Murphy
3. Announcement of winners of the "Unity" Poetry Contest- Dr. Edouard-Vincent
4. Report on the McGlynn Middle School - Principal Nick Tucci
5. Deadline for Secondary Cohorting Assignments: March 12, 2021 - David Murphy
6. Recommendation to approve Memorandum of Agreement between the Medford Public Schools and the Medford Paraprofessionals Association governing working conditions for the 2020 - 2021 school year. - Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent
7. Update on Medford High School Restroom Renovation Project - David Murphy
8. Report on User Fees for Athletics - Dr. Peter Cushing and Bobby Maloney

VIII. Old Business

1. The Annual Reports and Presentations Schedule Policy will be amended to change the frequency of the Tiered Focus Monitoring Presentation in Section III - Schedule from "annually" to "every three years".

Offered by: Paul Ruseau

IX. Communications

X. New Business

- 1. Motion to include the School Committee Voting Tally Sheet as part of the regular School Committee public record with posting to web-site on a regular basis.**

Offered by - Melanie McLaughlin

- 2. Motion to use the following guidelines at the March 10, 2021 Committee of the Whole Meeting with purpose of forming an Advisory Committee to rename the Columbus Elementary School.**

Offered by - Paul Ruseau

Resolution on the Advisory Committee to Rename the Columbus Elementary School

Whereas the Medford School Committee on June 15, 2020, voted to rename the Columbus Elementary School effective July 1, 2021, through the creation of an advisory committee that was to commence no later than October 1, 2020;

Whereas the Medford Public Schools has been engaged in the education of our students through a public health emergency and meeting the dates laid out in the motion of June 15, 2020, has not happened for various reasons;

Whereas Medford Public School policy BDF, Advisory Committees to the School Committee directs the establishment of advisory committees with required specifications;

Whereas all Medford Public Schools bare names with a connection to Medford, and the Committee wishes to retain that tradition;

Whereas the level of community involvement envisioned by the motion of June 15, 2020, and the timeline laid out therein is no longer feasible; now, therefore, be it

Resolved, that the Medford School Committee:

1. Hereby establishes an advisory committee pursuant to Medford Public Schools policy BDF, Advisory Committees to the School Committee;
2. The advisory committee will be named the ‘Columbus Elementary School Renaming Advisory Committee’ and referred to as the ‘Advisory Committee’ herein;
3. The Superintendent will create an application form for membership in the Advisory

Committee by 5 pm, Friday, March 12, 2021, the form will include at a minimum the following elements for the applicant to complete:

- a. full name (required)
- b. address (required)
- c. contact information (required)
- d. why do you want to be on this advisory committee? (required)
- e. suggested new name(s) for the school including the following:
 - i. name
 - ii. a brief explanation for why you think the name should be considered
 - iii. relationship of the suggestion to Medford
- f. are you a current or former member of the Columbus Elementary School community and if so how (student, family, staff)? (required)
- g. are you related to a School Committee Member and if so how? (required)
- h. will you require an interpreter? (required)
- i. do you have access to a computer and an internet connection to participate in Zoom meetings (if the answer is 'no' we can provide you with the technology)? (required)
- j. demographics information including (optional):
 - i. age category
 - ii. gender identity
 - iii. sexual orientation
 - iv. household income
 - v. educational attainment
 - vi. what language do you mainly speak at home
 - vii. racial/ethnic identity;

4. The Superintendent will create a name suggestion form by 5 pm, Friday, March 12, 2021.

This form will be used by members of the public who wish to submit a suggestion but do not wish to apply to the advisory committee. The form will include the following elements:

- a. full name (required)
- b. address (required)
- c. contact information (required)
- d. are you a current or former member of the Columbus Elementary School community and if so how (student, family, staff)? (required)
- e. suggested new name(s) for the school including the following:
 - i. name
 - ii. a brief explanation for why you think the name should be considered
 - iii. relationship of the suggestion to Medford

5. The application form and suggestion form will be posted on the Medford Public Schools website and communicated out through the usual mechanisms the district uses including translations to predominant languages on Monday, March 15, 2021, and again on Monday, March 22, 2021;

6. Paper versions of the application form and suggestion form will be made available and at

- least one notice will be printed in a Medford news publication of this process including how to attain and submit paper forms;
7. The application and suggestion form will open on Monday, March 15, 2021, and will close on Thursday, April 22, 2021, at 5 pm;
 8. Valid applications must meet all requirements:
 - a. submitted within the application period;
 - b. the applicant must be a current resident of Medford, Massachusetts;
 - c. the applicant cannot be a close relative of a School Committee Member, i.e., children, parents, siblings, or the spouses of children, parents, or siblings;
 - d. members of the School Committee may not apply;
 - e. all required elements of the application have been completed;
 9. Valid suggestions must meet all requirements:
 - a. submitted within the application period;
 - b. the submitter of the suggestion must be a current resident of Medford, Massachusetts;
 - c. all required elements of the suggestion form have been completed;
 10. The community of the Columbus Elementary School including students, families, and staff that are currently connected through student enrollment, or assignment to the building as staff, will receive particular attention in communications to ensure they are aware of the application and suggestion form and are urged to submit an application or name suggestion. Multiple communications to this community are recommended;
 11. Before April 22, 2021, the Principal of the Columbus Elementary School will select up to six Advisory Committee members from the current school staff and transmit the selections to the Superintendent. The selection of these six Advisory Committee members will be at the discretion of the Principal of the Columbus Elementary School and may include school leadership. Families of the Columbus Elementary School community are urged to apply for membership on the Advisory Committee through the public application process or to submit their suggestions via the suggestion form;
 12. Before April 22, 2021, the Principal of the Columbus Elementary School will transmit to the Superintendent one suggested new name which will be selected by the six Advisory Committee members from the Columbus Elementary School from the suggested names supplied by students as part of an optional school project to identify potential new names for the school;
 13. All applications and name suggestions received will be forwarded to the School Committee on Friday, April 23, 2021. Applications and suggested names should be identified as either valid or invalid, and invalid submissions should include the reason(s) for the determination. The suggested new name and six Advisory Committee members submitted by the Principal of the Columbus Elementary School will be provided to the School Committee in this transmission to prevent duplicate selection by the School Committee Members at the Committee of the Whole described below;
 14. On April 26, 2021, a Committee of the Whole will be held to determine the following: a. each School Committee Member will select *at most* two applicants for the Advisory

Committee from the valid applications received and state the names publicly. In the event that an applicant is selected by more than one School Committee Member, the School Committee will work out who will select a different applicant;

- b. Each School Committee Member will select and sort four suggested new names from the list of possible new names compiled from the applications and suggestion form submissions - assigning each of their preferred four suggested names a value from '4' (number 1 choice) to '1' (number 4 choice). The four names and the values assigned by each School Committee Member will be revealed publicly and from these preferred suggested names, the value associated with each will be added together. The four suggested names with the highest total value, in addition to the name provided by the Columbus Elementary School, will be the names that the Advisory Committee may consider in their work. In the event of a tie resulting in more than four suggested names or no overlap in selected names by the School Committee Members rendering a ranking impossible, the School Committee will decide how to proceed during this meeting to arrive at four selections. The current name of the school may not be considered and if a School Committee Member submits the current name it will not be considered;
- c. The four names selected by the School Committee, and the suggested new name provided by the Columbus Elementary School community, will be the five names the Advisory Committee may consider.
- d. The School Committee will elect a current School Committee Member to act as the Chair of the Advisory Committee for the sole purpose of administering the meetings, e.g., scheduling, meeting postings, and chairing meetings;
- 15. The Advisory Committee will consist of up to twenty-one individuals, up to fourteen members from the School Committee selection, six from the Columbus Elementary School, and one School Committee Member that will act as the Chair;
- 16. Only Advisory Committee members selected by the School Committee and the Principal of the Columbus Elementary School will be voting members of the Advisory Committee unless a tie arises in which case the Chair may cast the deciding vote;
- 17. Press relations will be directed through the Chair and members of the Advisory Committee are urged to send press contacts to the Chair;
- 18. Advisory Committee meetings are public meetings and must follow all requirements of the Open Meeting Law;
- 19. The Superintendent will provide a note-taker for the meetings and create minutes;
- 20. The Advisory Committee will meet a minimum of four times and a majority of voting members will be required to reach a quorum for the meeting;
- 21. How the Advisory Committee goes about their work is up to them;
- 22. Advisory Committee members may withdraw from participation by notifying the Chair and will not be counted in subsequent quorum and voting requirements. The Chair will notify the remaining members of the Advisory Committee of the reduction in membership. No new members will be added to the Advisory Committee due to vacancies;
- 23. An Advisory Committee member that refuses to communicate about scheduling or

participation may be removed from the Advisory Committee if the Chair determines that said individual is not participating, after a good faith effort to engage with the member. If this situation occurs the remaining members of the Advisory Committee will be notified of the reduction in the membership and the effect on voting requirements;

24. While consensus is always preferred, a simple majority of the total number of Advisory Committee members will be required to select the recommended new name of the Columbus Elementary School. In the event that all members of the Advisory Committee are not present for the final vote to select the recommended new name, a majority vote of the total number of advisory committee members is still required, not a majority of advisory committee members that are *present*;
25. The Advisory Committee will determine a single recommendation to be submitted to the School Committee and may not provide options or more than one recommendation;
26. The Advisory Committee will present their recommendation for the new name of the Columbus Elementary School on May 24, 2021. The recommendation can be provided in a format of their choosing but there is a preference that a presentation will be given explaining the way that the recommendation was arrived at and why the newly selected name was chosen; and
27. The Medford School Committee will vote on May 24, 2021, to approve the recommendation, given the authority for naming of public school buildings is our authority alone, per Massachusetts General Law.

3. Motion to use the following guidelines at the March 10, 2021 Committee of the Whole Meeting with purpose of forming an Advisory Committee to rename the Columbus Elementary School.

Offered by Paulette Van der Kloot

Resolution on the Advisory Committee to Rename the Columbus Elementary School

Please note: Because of the complexity of the process, I am submitting this for consideration during our March 10, 2021 Committee of the Whole meeting as a possible alternative to Member Ruseau's Advisory Committee resolution. Many elements are the same and directly taken from Member Ruseau's resolution but there are also significant differences. On the key point of final name selection, I have provided two options for school committee input.

Whereas the Medford School Committee on June 15, 2020, voted to rename the Columbus Elementary School effective July 1, 2021, through the creation of an advisory committee that was to commence no later than October 1, 2020;

Whereas the Medford Public Schools has been engaged in the education of our students through a public health emergency and the initial timeline is no longer feasible;

Whereas the Medford School Committee recognizes that community members have deep feelings about the renaming the Columbus School;

Resolved, that the Medford School Committee:

1. Hereby establishes an advisory committee pursuant to Medford Public Schools policy BDF, Advisory Committees to the School Committee;
2. The Advisory Committee will be named the ‘Columbus Elementary School Renaming Advisory Committee’ and referred to as the ‘Advisory Committee’ herein;
3. Charges the Advisory Committee with the task of vetting names submitted for consideration, and weighing the relative strength of submissions against a criteria they will develop. The criteria will include but not be limited to such factors as the potential for the name to bring the community together, the ability for the name to stand as a role model for Medford students, and the name as a representation of the Medford community’s proud history. Furthermore, the Advisory Committee is charged with narrowing the field of names to three finalists. These final names will (EITHER: left open for school committee input!)
 - A. be presented to the school committee with accompanying information about why the name is worthy of consideration. The school committee, after hearing supporting information, will choose a finalist with a majority vote necessary for selection.
 - B. the Advisory Committee narrows the field to their top selection which is presented to the school committee for their approval. (This cedes the role of name selection to the Advisory Committee.)

SUBMISSION OF NAMES FOR CONSIDERATION

The school committee will request the Superintendent of her designee to develop a form to be used to submit names for consideration. The form will include the following:

1. Full name (required)
2. Address (required)
3. Contact information
4. Are you a current or former member of the Columbus Elementary School community?
5. Name you are suggesting and a brief explanation of why you think the name should be considered.
6. Relationship of the suggestion to Medford
7. Are you related to the name you submitted? If so, how?
8. Any other information that you can provide to the Advisory Committee for their consideration.
9. Individuals applying to be on the Advisory Committee may submit names.
10. Each name submitted for consideration should be listed on a separate forms.
11. The name of Christopher Columbus will not be considered a valid submission.

PARTICIPATION BY THE COLUMBUS SCHOOL STAFF and STUDENTS

In recognition that the staff and students of the Columbus School are dedicated to their school, the School Committee requests the Principal to create a representative group of staff to solicit input from their colleagues. Additionally, student input is highly desirable and if it is feasible student participation will be encouraged in any way the Principal deems to be workable in this very short period of time. The goal of both staff and student input is to come up with 3-5 names to submit for consideration to the Advisory Committee. Names will be submitted by April 26, 2021

Further, the Principal of the Columbus or her designee as well as two staff members selected by their peers (or Appointed by the Principal?) will be appointed as voting members to the Advisory Committee.

ADVISORY COMMITTEE SELECTION

1. The school committee will request the Superintendent or her designee to develop an application for those interested in serving on the Advisory Committee. The Advisory committee will consist of

- a. Full name (required)
- b. Address (required)
- c. Contact information (required)
- d. Why do you want to be on this advisory committee? (required)
- e. Availability (is applicant available in late afternoon, evenings, weekends, only certain days?)
- f. Are you a current or former member of the Columbus Elementary School community and if so how (student, family, staff)? (required)
- g. Demographics information including (optional):
 - i. age category
 - ii. gender identity
 - iii. sexual orientation
 - iv. household income
 - v. educational attainment
 - vi. what language do you mainly speak at home
 - vii. racial/ethnic identity;

The application provided by the Superintendent will state clearly that interpretation services will be available to any community members who so request and technology, i.e. laptop, camera, microphone (for remote participation) will also be provided upon request of a community member.

2. The application form and suggestion form will be posted on the Medford Public Schools website and communicated out through the usual mechanisms the district uses including translations to predominant languages on Monday, March 15, 2021, and again on Monday, March 22, 2021;

3. The application and submission period will open on Monday, March 15 and close on Friday, April 16, 2021, at 5 pm;

4. Valid applications must meet all requirements:

- a. submitted within the application period;
- b. the applicant must be a current resident of Medford, Massachusetts;
- c. the applicant cannot be a close relative of a School Committee Member, i.e., children, parents, siblings, or the spouses of children, parents, or siblings;
- d. members of the School Committee may not apply;
- e. all required elements of the application have been completed;

5. By April 16, 2021, the Principal of the Columbus School, will select two Advisory Committee members from the Columbus Elementary School staff and transmit the selections to the School Committee. Families of the Columbus Elementary School community are urged to apply for membership on the Advisory Committee through the public application process or to submit their suggestions via the suggestion form;

6. By April 16, 2021, a Medford High School student who attended the Columbus School, is a member of the C.C.S.R., and who is able to make the time commitment will be selected by his/her/their peers to be a member of the Advisory Committee.

7. On April 26, 2021, a Committee of the Whole will be held to select and confirm the 15 voting members Advisory Committee and one ex officio member as follows:

- A. The **two** names selected from the Columbus School staff, **Principal Kathy Kay**, and the **one** MHS student will be announced.
- B. Each School Committee Member will select a member for the Advisory Committee from the valid applications received and will state the names publicly. In the event that an applicant is selected by more than one School Committee Member, the members will continue to name applicants until a total of **seven** Advisory Committee members have been named by the School Committee.
- C. **Three** additional names will be selected by lottery from the remaining applicants.
- D. The Mayor will appoint one additional person to serve as Chair of the Advisory Committee. The Chair will be responsible for scheduling meetings, posting meetings, chairing meetings and organizing a presentation to the School Committee once the final names are determined. The Chair will be a voting member of the Advisory Committee. The Mayor will announce the Chair of the Committee prior to the selection of other members. Current School Committee members will not be considered for this position.
- E. The Mayor will reach out to the Medford Historical Society to enlist the help of a member who will serve as a resource to the Advisory Committee. The historian will be an ex officio (non-voting) member.

WORK OF THE ADVISORY COMMITTEE

1. At the April 26 Committee of the Whole Meeting, a list of the names submitted for consideration will be made public and forwarded to the Advisory Committee. Additionally, 3-5 names selected

by staff, students, and family representatives of the Columbus Elementary School community as part of an optional school project to identify potential new names for the school will be announced and forwarded to the Advisory Committee for consideration.

2. A file containing the emails from community members on the topic of the renaming will be made available to the Advisory Committee members so that all Advisory Committee members are aware of the opinions and concerns expressed by our community.

3. The Advisory Committee will develop criteria for evaluating the names. The Advisory Committee will determine the process for vetting the names, narrowing the field and submitting three finalists to the school committee.

4. Press relations will be directed through the Advisory Committee chair and members of the Advisory Committee are urged to send press contacts to the Chair;

5. Advisory Committee meetings are public meetings and must follow all requirements of the Open Meeting Law;

6. The Superintendent will provide a note-taker and create minutes;

7. It is expected that the Advisory Committee will need to meet three to five times and a majority of voting members will be required to reach a quorum for the meeting;

8. The Advisory Committee will hold at least one public hearing to solicit feedback on the options they are considering per the charge of this resolution as at least one of their meetings;

9. Advisory Committee members may withdraw from participation by notifying the Chair and will not be counted in subsequent quorum and voting requirements. The Chair will notify the remaining members of the Advisory Committee of the reduction in membership. No new members will be added to the Advisory Committee due to vacancies;

10. While consensus is always preferred, a simple majority of the total number of Advisory Committee members will be required to select up to three names that will be forwarded to the school committee.

(NOTE: If the School Committee votes to have the Advisory choose the final name then the Advisory Committee will do that and forward to the School Committee their recommendation for approval.)

11. The Advisory Committee will present their recommendations for the new name(s) of the Columbus Elementary School no later than May 24, 2021. A presentation will be given explaining the way that the recommendation was arrived at and why the selected name(s) was/were chosen.

FINAL SELECTION OF THE NEW NAME

Once the Medford School Committee has received the names and presentation, the Committee will vote either that evening or at a subsequent meeting not later than June 7, 2021 to approve the recommendation, given the authority for naming of public school buildings the School Committee's authority alone, per Massachusetts General Law.

4. School Committee Resolution: Condolences

The Medford School Committee expresses its sincere condolences to the family of Herbert Edward Wells, a long time teacher and Assistant Principal at the Brooks Hobbs complex and former assistant football coach at Medford High School.

The Medford School Committee expresses its sincere condolences to the family of AnnMarie Medeiros, mother of Lisa Malone, an administrative assistant for the Office of Pupil Services.

The Medford School Committee expresses its sincere condolences to the family of John C. Feitor, father-in-law of Medford High School science teacher Audrey Feitor and father of former Medford High School Band Director John R. Feitor.

The Medford School Committee expresses its sincere condolences to the family of Robert VanWinkle, husband of former Brooks Elementary School Para Lisa VanWinkle.